Chavarría (b. 1933) made Cuba his permanent home, while Mario Benedetti passed part of his exile, also from Uruguay, there. Others like Colombia's Gabriel García Márquez maintained close ties there.

Cuba's Revolution, and its literature and institutions, also served as an inspiration to the Latin American genre of *testimonio* or testimony in the 1980s. Miguel Barnet's *Biografía de un cimarrón*, published in 1966, was probably the seminal work of the genre. The Casa de las Américas Prize, and the fostering of the genre and its practitioners there, nourished the environment that gave birth to classic works like *I, Rigoberta Menchu*. Venezuelan anthropologist Elisabeth Burgos-Debray had met with Guatemalan revolutionaries at the Tricontinental Conference in Havana in 1966; they later brought Rigoberta to meet with her in Paris, where the two collaborated on the testimony.[19] The book won the Casa de las Américas Prize in 1983, catapulting it to international recognition. Salvadoran revolutionary poet Roque Dalton spent time in exile in Cuba, as did the subject of the celebrated testimony that he later authored, Salvadoran Communist leader Miguel Mármol.

In terms of literary criticism, González Echevarría notes that "the less academic and more popular a work, the more militant it is."[20] In this respect, literary criticism mirrored nonfiction and scholarly writing in general. Cuba's daily newspapers drummed a relentlessly celebratory party line about current events, even while more specialized publications took a much more sober and in-depth view of matters.

Except for in the case of testimony, revolutionary Cuba's impact on the Latin American literary world probably had as much to do with the institutions it created than with the actual literary production since the Revolution. In the areas of film, music, and visual and especially poster art, in contrast, revolutionary Cuba's innovations and works had a dramatic impact both domestically and internationally.

Film

The Cuban film institute, ICAIC (the Instituto Cubano de Arte e Industria Cinematográficos or Cuban Institute of Cinematographic Arts